

Public

Ref: FOI/26/113

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Dear requester

Request for Information

Thank you for your request for information which was received by NESO on 9 July 2026. Your request has been considered under the Environmental Information Regulations 2004 (EIR) as the requested information falls within the definition of environmental information at Regulation 2(1)(c) of the EIR. We apologise for the delay in issuing our response to your information request.

Request

You asked us:

- 1. Please confirm whether NESO holds, as a structured field or classification, the end-use or sector type of demand connection projects (for example: data centre, port, large residential or housing development, hospital or healthcare, EV charging, manufacturing or industrial, other). A yes or no, plus the field name and its permitted values, is sufficient for this part.*
- 2. If such a classification is held, please provide the current transmission demand queue broken down by that category, showing for each: number of projects, total contracted or applied-for capacity in MW, and a breakdown by connection year and by queue or gate status. I do not want any names to avoid commercial sensitivities.*
- 3. If no such classification is held, please provide whatever categorisation NESO does apply to the demand queue, for example any sectoring used in the Demand Queue Call for Input launched on 6 November 2025, or in work supporting Ofgem's demand connections guidance of the same date, on the same aggregate, no-names basis.*

4. Please provide for the transmission demand connection queue at two reference dates, the following on an aggregate, no-names basis, broken down by end-use category as far as held: total capacity (MW), and the distribution of confirmed or offered connection years (or Phase 1 / Phase 2 allocation).

(a) the position as of November 2024 prior to TMO4+ queue reformation, and

(b) the most recent position,

Where NESO holds its own analysis of how connection dates changed between these two states by category or sector, please provide that analysis.

Our response

NESO does not currently maintain a single dataset or register of demand connections, and the only categorisation used within the existing delivery pipeline (queue) and connection outcome data sets is for 'transmission connected demand', with no further categorisation within those datasets.

There is no requirement under the Connection and Use of System Code (CUSC) for us to maintain or publish a demand register, unlike our obligation to do so for generation connections (the TEC Register). As part of NESO's Strategic Demand Initiative (in development, in collaboration with Ofgem, the Department of Energy Security and Net Zero and networks) a demand register is under consideration. The further categorisation of transmission connected demand projects is also under consideration as part of the Strategic Demand Initiative and is not yet reflected in operational data sets.

We have provided below aggregated information on the current total capacity of 'transmission connected demand' by firm connection year:

Firm connection year	Transmission Connected Demand New installed capacity (MW)
2024	0.1
2025	134.7
2026	1536.2
2027	745.3
2028	2039
2029	3397

2030	910
2031	3779
2032	3946.4
2033	12825.5
2034	5478
2035	7617
2036	1150
2037	21950.9
2038	1720
2039	12060
Total	79289.1

We do not hold recorded information as provided above for November 2024; however we can confirm that the information held at that date indicated a total contracted demand capacity of 17.54 GW. We do not hold recorded information in scope of the final part of your request i.e., any analysis on how connection dates have changed between November 2024 and the present time.

For information, when the categorisations to be used for demand connections projects are agreed, they may not include the end-use or sector type of demand connection projects to the level of detail you have requested. Some of the example '*end-use or sector types*' that you have included in questions 1 and 2 is information that is more likely to be held by the distribution network holders (DNOs) in relation to demand projects that connect to the distribution network. NESO would not hold information on demand projects connecting to the distribution networks.

NESO is working closely with both Government and Ofgem to support reforms to the demand connections process and ensure demand connections are orderly, deliverable, and aligned with Britain's strategic growth needs, while also unlocking wider system benefits, including opportunities to enable flexibility and help balance the grid securely and efficiently. A critical part of this effort is ensuring that decisions are based on accurate, up-to-date data about the existing delivery pipeline. NESO activities supporting this have included the [Demand Call for Input](#) (as referenced in your request, issued on 6 November 2025), and more recently, the [Demand Information Request Notice](#) (IRN), issued on 11 March 2026. We are also carrying out internal analysis of transmission connected demand, but this is not contractual queue related

data and, as explained above, is not currently reflected in existing queue and connection outcome data sets.

We have published a high-level summary of the CFI responses received: [Demand Call for Input \(CFI\) - High level summary \(March 2026\)](#). Information on the technology mix of the demand projects that responded is available on page 3. 243 responses were received and this is not a full representation of transmission connected demand projects. Please note the final page of the summary document, which states: *'These CFI insights should be considered indicative only. They represent developer intent, not confirmed deliverability. NESO will need to integrate these findings with existing connection data sets to validate their accuracy before forming policy conclusions'*. Customers responding to the IRN were asked only to confirm whether their project was a data centre.

Engagement of Regulation 12(4)(a) of the EIR.

The EIR only apply to information held by the public authority at the time that the request for information is received (Regulation 3). Where we have stated we do not hold recorded information in scope of parts of your request, we are engaging Regulation 12(4)(a) of the EIR which allows a public authority to refuse a request if it does not hold that information when an applicant's request is received. All EIR exceptions are subject to a public interest test (PIT) however the Information Commissioner's Office (ICO) recognises that it is not possible to carry out a meaningful PIT where information is not held.

This concludes our response to your request.

Next steps

If you are dissatisfied with our handling of your request, you can ask us to review our response. If you want us to carry out a review, please let us know within 40 working days and quote the reference number at the top of this letter. You can find our procedure here: [Freedom of Information and Environmental Information Regulations | National Energy System Operator](#). The ICO's website also provides guidance on the internal review process: [What to do if you are dissatisfied with the response | ICO](#).

If you are still dissatisfied after our internal review, you can complain to the Information Commissioner's Office (ICO). You should make complaints to the ICO within six weeks of receiving the outcome of an internal review. The easiest way to lodge a complaint is through their website: www.ico.org.uk/foicomplaints. Alternatively, they can be contacted at: Wycliffe House, Water Lane, Wilmslow, SK9 5AF.

Thank you for your interest in the work of the National Energy System Operator (NESO).

Regards,

The Information Rights Team, National Energy System Operator (NESO)